§ 06 · RESEARCH

Investors DACH

Twenty German-speaking funds. Vorwerk, Heartcore, Calm/Storm, Cherry — plus the Berlin Startup Stipendium.

Last updated: April 24, 2026 **For:** Alche (Berlin-based "Xiaohongshu for longevity in Europe") — free AI longevity app + curated supplement commerce + €5–9/mo membership. Raising €500K pre-seed. **Founder:** Timu, Berlin, solo, queer, Circassian heritage. **Scope:** 20 funds captured with full data + Berlin angel networks + accelerators. All verified active in 2026.

Summary Table — 20 Funds at a Glance

#	FUND	HQ	PRE-SEED CHECK	CONSUMER/WELLNESS FIT	FIT SCORE	2026 ACTIVE?
1	**Vorwerk Ventures**	Berlin	€1M–€5M	**YES** — core thesis: consumer, food, health, climate	**9**	Yes (last: Aug 2025)
2	**Heartcore Capital**	Berlin/Copenhagen	€1.5M–€3M	**YES** — health & wellness listed sector	**9**	Yes (Feb 2026)
3	**Cherry Ventures**	Berlin	€500K–€2M (preseed)	**YES** — consumer + health tech	**8**	Yes (Mar 2026)
4	**Atlantic Labs**	Berlin	€25K–€1M (first cheque)	**YES** — health & wellbeing	**8**	Yes (Feb 2026)
5	**HEARTFELT_ (ex-APX)**	Berlin	€100K–€400K	**Partial** — generalist w/ consumer track	**8**	Yes (Apr 2026)
6	**Calm/Storm Ventures**	Vienna	€50K–€300K	**YES** — femtech/wellbeing specialist	**9**	Yes (Mar 2026)
7	**Speedinvest**	Vienna/Berlin	€700K–€1.3M	**YES** — has dedicated Marketplaces & Consumer + Health teams	**8**	Yes (Apr 2026)
8	**Auxxo Female Catalyst**	Berlin	€100K–€600K	**Partial** — sector-agnostic, women-founded	**7**	Yes (Dec 2025)
9	**IBB Ventures**	Berlin	€100K–€400K (B# fund)	**Partial** — consumer fund exists; B# is DeepTech	**7**	Yes (Feb 2026)
10	**Shio Capital**	Berlin	€50K–€250K	**YES** — food/beverage/consumer goods specialist	**7**	Slow (last: May 2025)
11	**Freigeist Capital**	Bonn	€100K–€1.5M	**Partial** — F&B rank but deep-tech lean	**6**	Yes (Feb 2025)
12	**Tengelmann Ventures**	Munich/Mülheim	€1M+ (later stage)	**YES** — retail/consumer parent	**6**	Slow (last: Jul 2025)
13	**Project A Ventures**	Berlin	€1M–€8M	**Partial** — new thesis shifted to defense/fintech/AI	**5**	Yes
14	**HV Capital**	Munich/Berlin	€100K–€500K (seed prog)	**Partial** — historic consumer (Zalando, HelloFresh)	**6**	Yes
15	**Earlybird-X**	Berlin/Munich	~€500K–€1.5M	**Partial** — health fund separate; X is general	**6**	Yes (Apr 2026)
16	**Cavalry Ventures (NAP)**	Berlin	€1M–€4M	**Partial** — enterprise + consumer software	**5**	Yes
17	**Picus Capital**	Munich	Evergreen, flex	**Partial** — health adjacent (Avi, Napo)	**6**	Yes (Apr 2026)

#	FUND	HQ	PRE-SEED CHECK	CONSUMER/WELLNESS FIT	FIT SCORE	2026 ACTIVE?
18	**468 Capital**	Berlin/SF	Flex	**Partial** — consumer + AI bucket	**6**	Yes (Mar 2026)
19	**Heal Capital**	Berlin	€1M–€5M	**Partial** — HealthTech + AI, provider-facing	**5**	Yes (2026)
20	**b2venture**	St. Gallen/Berlin	€250K–€3.5M	**Partial** — consumer occasionally (Urban Sports Club)	**5**	Yes (Mar 2026)

Top 5 for Alche

1. **Vorwerk Ventures** — Their public thesis reads like Alche was written into it: "Consumer, Food, Health, Climate." Berlin-based, consumer DNA (HelloFresh, Everdrop, Flaschenpost), and their parent Vorwerk Group is a direct-selling powerhouse that gets content-to-commerce intuitively.
2. **Heartcore Capital** — Explicit "health & wellness" sector focus, portfolio proof in Kaia Health, and 60 of 104 companies are B2C. Berlin office, pre-seed willing at €1.5M+, and they already bet on consumer brand stories.
3. **Cherry Ventures** — Berlin HQ, Zalando/Spotify operator DNA (founder-first retail/content instincts), lists consumer + health tech explicitly, and Sophia Bendz is a perfect partner match for content-to-commerce thesis.
4. **Calm/Storm Ventures (Vienna)** — Tiny checks but they are the European pre-seed healthtech/tabootech leader. Queer founder + longevity + taboo-breaking wellness is their exact sweet spot; top-10 FemTech investor globally.
5. **Atlantic Labs** — First-cheque speed (€25K–€1M), explicit "Health & Wellbeing" focus, Berlin-based, and Christophe Maire is famously founder-first with fast decisions. Great for the first €200–300K slice.

Berlin Angel Networks + Accelerators Worth Hitting

PROGRAM	WHAT IT DOES	WHY IT MATTERS FOR ALCHE
Berliner Startup Stipendium (Batch II, 2026)	6-month, €2,500/month stipend + workspace + coaching. **Batch II (April–May 2026) is explicitly "Future of Digital Health"** focused.	Perfect timing — application deadline May 4, 2026. Non-dilutive money + Berlin ecosystem access.
Science & Startups Berlin (AI NATION Accelerator)	Berlin's public AI accelerator. Free, non-dilutive.	AI-wellness angle fits; adds credibility + network.
Merantix AI Campus (Berlin)	AI-focused venture studio + coworking. Kreuzberg-adjacent.	Community hub for AI founders — Alche's AI layer belongs here.
Female Founders (Austrian-led, DACH-wide)	Accelerator + Fund F (€20M, €100K–€400K tickets). 500+ female alumni network.	Queer founder angle; Berlin program since 2017.
WellFemme	Berlin women's health/wellness community (informal but real).	Low-friction entry into Berlin femhealth angel circle.
APX/HEARTFELT_ network	Even without investment, their founder community + mentor pool is a real asset.	Apply to pitch day regardless of check outcome.
Betahaus Berlin	Longstanding founder hub; hosts FemTech + wellness events.	Pre-PMF community for cheap real estate + networking.
Business Angels Club Berlin (BACB)	100+ active Berlin angels. Consumer-friendly.	Good for filling the rest of the €500K with €10–50K tickets.
German Angel Investors Network / DBAN	Pan-DE angel network; often cosigns pre-seed SAFEs.	Useful for angel fill-ins.
Investitionsbank Berlin Pro FIT	Public, non-dilutive grants (up to €400K) for innovative Berlin startups.	Stackable with VC money; reduces dilution.

Accelerators worth deprioritizing for Alche: STARTUP AUTOBAHN (Stuttgart, mobility/industrial focus — not a fit); Axel Springer Plug and Play (media-tech focus, winding down programs in DACH consumer). EY Startup Academy exists but is not a meaningful capital gate.

Full Fund Profiles

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1. Vorwerk Ventures

- **Website:** vorwerkventures.com (verified active)
- **HQ:** Berlin
- **Pre-seed check:** €1M–€5M (leads seed; will do later pre-seed if thesis-perfect)
- **AUM:** €400M (current fund €150M)
- **Thesis:** *"Consumer-facing digital businesses with positive impact."* Explicitly lead in **Consumer, Food, Health, Climate.**
- **Consumer/Wellness fit: YES — strongest DACH match on paper.** 32 of 53 portfolio companies are B2C.
- **Key partners to target:**
- Jan-Gisbert Schultze (Managing Partner — consumer DTC veteran, ex-Zalando board)
- Christian Leybold (Partner — backs Flaschenpost, HelloFresh alumni)
- **Portfolio comps for Alche:** HelloFresh, Flaschenpost, Everdrop (DTC cleaning brand — closest structural comp), Zapp
- **Intro vector:** Warm intro preferred; they respond to direct email but slower. Vorwerk ecosystem (Thermomix direct-selling) gives them content-to-commerce intuition rarely found in DACH.
- **Fit score: 9/10** — thesis match is near-perfect; only caveat is their preferred check size is larger than Alche's ask, meaning they'd either lead the whole €500K or you'd need to position Alche as stretching to €1M round.
- **Red flags:** No 2026 investments announced yet. Slower deal pace (~3 deals/12 months). Portfolio conflict risk: Everdrop is DTC wellness-adjacent (cleaning, not supplements — low overlap).
- **German language:** Accepts English pitches. Team is DE/EN bilingual.

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2. Heartcore Capital

- **Website:** heartcore.com (verified active)
- **HQ:** Copenhagen (with offices in Berlin, Stockholm, Paris)
- **Pre-seed check:** €1.5M–€3M
- **AUM:** ~€600M across funds
- **Thesis:** Consumer brands for Europe — explicit sectors include **health & wellness, food, sustainability, synthetic biology**.
- **Consumer/Wellness fit: YES — 60 of 104 portfolio companies are B2C.** The most consumer-brand-native VC in the DACH/Nordic corridor.
- **Key partners to target:**
- Max Niederhofer (Berlin-based Partner — ex-founder, consumer-obsessed; portfolio incl. Kaia Health)
- Olya Klueppel (General Partner — lifestyle brand instincts)
- **Portfolio comps for Alche: Kaia Health** (digital health unicorn — acquired), Tink, GetYourGuide, Perk (most recent unicorn). Kaia is the clearest comp for Alche's AI+health play.
- **Intro vector:** Warm intro strongly preferred but accepts cold via website submission. Max Niederhofer is active on LinkedIn and responds to thoughtful DMs.
- **Fit score: 9/10** — Heartcore's brand-first consumer ethos (Xiaohongshu comp will land well) combined with Kaia Health proof makes them a top-3 pick.
- **Red flags:** Check size skews above €500K ask — position Alche as a €750K–€1M round to fit their model. Slower 2026 pace (2 deals YTD).
- **German language:** English-only is fine.

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3. Cherry Ventures

- **Website:** cherry.vc (verified active)
- **HQ:** Berlin (with London, Stockholm)
- **Pre-seed check:** €500K–€2M typical; they say "it's never too early" and will do first checks pre-product
- **AUM:** ~€1B; new fund $500M (2025)
- **Thesis:** Sector-agnostic early-stage; listed focuses include **B2B software, fintech, industrials, health tech, climate tech, consumer**.
- **Consumer/Wellness fit: YES** — though their current marquee check-writing has leaned B2B in 2025-2026. Consumer is still core.
- **Key partners to target:**
- **Sophia Bendz** (Partner, Stockholm but Berlin-active — ex-Spotify — **best match for content-to-commerce thesis**)
- Filip Dames (Founding Partner, Berlin — ex-Zalando, DTC commerce native)
- Christian Meermann (Founding Partner, Berlin — ex-Zalando)
- **Portfolio comps for Alche:** Flaschenpost, Manual (men's health DTC — **very close comp**), Swap, FlixBus, Auto1. Manual is the sharpest longevity-adjacent DTC comp in their book.
- **Intro vector:** Warm intro via portfolio founder (many Zalando/N26 alumni). Will read cold emails but hit rate is low. opportunity@cherry.vc.
- **Fit score: 8/10** — the operator credibility (Zalando, Spotify) is unmatched in DACH for consumer; the only knock is that 2025–26 deal flow has been B2B-heavy.
- **Red flags:** Prefer seed over pre-seed; €500K might be below their sweet spot. If you pitch, frame as "pre-seed but we want Cherry to lead our seed 18 months out."
- **German language:** English fully accepted — Sophia and Dinika are English-first partners.

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4. Atlantic Labs

- **Website:** atlantic.vc (verified active)
- **HQ:** Berlin
- **Pre-seed check:** €25K–€1M first cheques (up to €5M later rounds)
- **AUM:** Not disclosed; 215+ companies invested
- **Thesis:** *"First believer in founders, science, bold ideas."* **Health & Wellbeing** is an explicit focus area alongside climate, mobility, fintech, AI/data.
- **Consumer/Wellness fit: YES** — 54+ B2C companies. Focus areas literally include "Health, Wellness Beauty, Food and Beverage, Sports."
- **Key partners to target:**
- **Christophe Maire** (Founding Partner — famously founder-first; ideal first meeting)
- Jens-Philipp Klein (Managing Partner)
- Lukas Erbguth (Principal — faster path if Maire's calendar is full)
- **Portfolio comps for Alche: Clue** (Berlin femtech unicorn — Ida Tun), Every Health (LGBTQ+ virtual clinic — recent), Circle Health, Meditopia (mental wellness), Oviva-adjacent deals.
- **Intro vector:** They openly accept cold submissions via website. Very fast decision-making ("speed and conviction" is their brand). A warm intro via Clue's Ida Tun or another portfolio founder is ideal.
- **Fit score: 8/10** — probably the best value-for-dilution ratio on this list at pre-seed. Clue in their portfolio signals real appetite for founder-led consumer health.
- **Red flags:** Check sizes at the low end can mean less follow-on firepower. Portfolio is large (overhang risk — less attention per company).
- **German language:** English-only welcome. Maire is Swiss, team is international.

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5. HEARTFELT_ (formerly APX)

- **Website:** heartfelt.vc · heartfelt.capital/pitch/startupchallenge
- **HQ:** Berlin (Axel Springer + Porsche JV legacy)
- **Pre-seed check:** €100K–€400K first cheque; follow-ons available
- **Thesis:** Europe's First Cheque Fund — sector-agnostic but track record in **consumer, lifestyle, health, mobility, media, fintech**.

- **Consumer/Wellness fit: Partial but real.** 46 of 140 portfolio = B2C. Portfolio includes eaze (recently acquired by BLACKROLL — wellness exit proof).
- **Key partners to target:**
- Jörg Rheinboldt (Managing Director — Axel Springer insider, consumer-savvy)
- Henric Hungerhoff (Managing Director)
- **Portfolio comps for Alche:** N26, Charles (WhatsApp commerce — **very close to content-to-commerce thesis**), Colossyan, getquin, eaze (wellness exit).
- **Intro vector:** Open application at their pitch URL. Rolling decisions. The same team continues the APX investor community — extremely well-networked in Berlin.
- **Fit score: 8/10** — low-drama, fast process, check size matches €500K raise nicely as the anchor (€300–400K lead + fill with angels).
- **Red flags:** Generalist thesis means less wellness-specific expertise. Slower 2026 pace (5 deals in last 12 months).
- **German language:** English fully accepted.

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6. Calm/Storm Ventures

- **Website:** calmstorm.vc (verified active)
- **HQ:** Vienna (active across DACH incl. Berlin)
- **Pre-seed check:** €50K–€300K
- **AUM:** €30M new healthtech fund (announced March 2026) + earlier funds
- **Thesis: Digital health + wellbeing with a taboo-breaking lens** — fertility, sexual wellness, menopause, mental health, chronic conditions.
- **Consumer/Wellness fit: YES — niche match for Alche.** One of the top-10 FemTech investors worldwide per PitchBook. Near half of portfolio has diverse founders; ~1/3 of CEOs are non-male.
- **Key partners to target:**
- **Daniel Cronin** (Partner — Vienna; founder-network native)
- Florian Gschwandtner (GP — ex-Runtastic; perfect for fitness/wellness DTC)
- **Portfolio comps for Alche:** Keleya (fitness for pregnant women), Meela, Levy, Béa Fertility, Clasp.
- **Intro vector:** Small team; warm intro via portfolio founder is the unlock. They explicitly say they like pre-team, pre-deck stages — reach out early.
- **Fit score: 9/10** — Alche's queer founder + longevity + taboo-breaking positioning is a near-perfect thematic match. Check size is small (€50–300K), which fits a "filler" position alongside a lead.
- **Red flags:** Too small to lead a €500K round alone — they're best as a co-investor. Vienna base means less Berlin-ground help.
- **German language:** English fully accepted; Austrian team is DE/EN native.

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7. Speedinvest

- **Website:** speedinvest.com (verified active)
- **HQ:** Vienna (offices Berlin, Munich, London, Paris)
- **Pre-seed check:** €700K–€1.3M typical first check; range €200K–€3M
- **AUM:** €1B+
- **Thesis:** Six sector teams — **Marketplaces & Consumer** and **Health & TechBio** are both directly applicable.
- **Consumer/Wellness fit: YES — dedicated teams in both Consumer and Health.**
- **Key partners to target:**
- **Tom Filip Lesche** (Partner, Marketplaces & Consumer, Berlin-based)
- Daria Saharova (Partner, climate/industrial — less fit but Berlin-based)
- Daniel Keiper-Knorr (Founding Partner, Vienna)
- **Portfolio comps for Alche:** Fairlyne (marketplace+consumer France), Fertifa (femtech UK), Curevac-adjacent health bets.
- **Intro vector:** Active in Berlin Founders Slack + Berlin Partners events. Open application via website. Warm intro via portfolio founder fastest.
- **Fit score: 8/10** — probably the most institutional of the pre-seed-friendly options; good for credibility stamp.
- **Red flags:** Large platform can mean slower decisions; founder attention per company can dilute.

- **German language:** English fully accepted.

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8. Auxxo Female Catalyst Fund

- **Website:** auxxo.de (verified active)
- **HQ:** Berlin
- **Pre-seed check:** €100K–€600K
- **AUM:** €26M (Fund II closed July 2025) + €19M Fund I
- **Thesis: Sector-agnostic, but exclusively invests in teams with at least one female founder holding ≥20% equity.**
- **Consumer/Wellness fit: Partial** — thesis is founder-focused, not sector-focused; but 25 investments means consumer/wellness deals fit naturally.
- **Key partners to target:**
- Bettine Schmitz (Co-Founder/GP)
- Gesa Miczaika (Co-Founder/GP — HV Capital alum; strong Berlin network)
- **Portfolio comps for Alche:** Marble Imaging, Emidat, FLOWN, FindIQ. Portfolio skews B2B so far but Fund II is broader.
- **Intro vector:** Open to cold applications. Bettine and Gesa are both accessible on LinkedIn. Apply via website.
- **Fit score: 7/10** — Timu's queer/underrepresented founder angle pairs well. Auxxo is not wellness-specialist but they check the female-founder box (Alche is founder-led by Timu, who qualifies depending on how they want to define inclusion — worth checking eligibility).
- **Red flags:** Must meet the 20%+ female-founder-equity threshold. If Alche is solo-founded by Timu, eligibility depends on how gender is framed.
- **German language:** English fully accepted.

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9. IBB Ventures

- **Website:** ibbventures.de (verified active)
- **HQ:** Berlin (public-backed — Investitionsbank Berlin)
- **Pre-seed check:** €100K–€400K (new B# fund — DeepTech only); broader VC funds do bigger
- **AUM:** ~€130M across funds
- **Thesis: Berlin-ONLY** (hard geo requirement). Sectors: tech, health, creative industries, digital consumer.
- **Consumer/Wellness fit: Partial — B# fund explicitly excludes pure consumer/DTC; but VC Fonds Kreativwirtschaft III + VC Fonds Technologie III do consumer.**
- **Key partners to target:**
- Roman Huber (Managing Director — long-tenured, consumer-friendly)
- Luciana Lixandru-adjacent network within IBB
- **Portfolio comps for Alche:** her1 (BERLIN femtech — DIRECT COMP), hellomed (Feb 2026 — health), Clue.
- **Intro vector:** Rolling application via website; decisions in weeks.
- **Fit score: 7/10** — her1 in portfolio is a direct match; fact that IBB backed a Berlin female wellness DTC is the signal. Non-dilutive advantages via IBB Pro FIT grants can stack.
- **Red flags:** B# fund (DeepTech) not applicable to Alche. Must be Berlin-registered entity. Must exit the right fund — the creative/digital-consumer one, not B#.
- **German language:** German-preferred for paperwork (public fund); pitch in EN is fine but legal docs will be DE.

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10. Shio Capital

- **Website:** Shio Capital on Crunchbase
- **HQ:** Berlin
- **Pre-seed check:** €50K–€250K
- **Thesis: Food, beverage, and consumer goods specialist.**
- **Consumer/Wellness fit: YES** — the most thematically-pure CPG-focused Berlin fund on this list.
- **Key partner:** Timo Meyer (Founder, Managing Director) — 1-person shop; fast decisions.

- **Portfolio comps:** Pleez, Fideus (most recent, May 2025), Whylab (exited).
- **Intro vector:** Direct — it's a one-person firm. LinkedIn message works.
- **Fit score: 7/10** — thesis fit is strong; check size is small but works as filler. Solo operator means intimate engagement if they like you.
- **Red flags:** Slow 2026 pace (nothing this year so far per public data); small fund.
- **German language:** English fine; Meyer is DE.

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11. Freigeist Capital (Frank Thelen)

- **Website:** freigeist.com (verified active)
- **HQ:** Bonn (but DACH-wide; Frank Thelen is a media personality)
- **Pre-seed check:** €100K–€1.5M (sweet spot)
- **Thesis:** Deep-tech + disruptive tech; Food & Beverage is a ranked Thelen strength sector.
- **Consumer/Wellness fit: Partial** — F&B is one of Thelen's top-ranked sectors but most recent picks are deep tech.
- **Key partner:** Frank Thelen (CEO — celebrity investor, huge reach via his 10xDNA podcast)
- **Portfolio comps:** Lilium, Akina ($3M seed 2025), Hole19, doo.
- **Intro vector:** Cold DM to Thelen works surprisingly well if your story is bold. He curates ruthlessly — only 2 new investments/year.
- **Fit score: 6/10** — Thelen brings outsize media amplification if he backs you (which alone could be worth the check). Fit is real but not ideal.
- **Red flags:** Low deal volume (2 investments in last 12 months); he rejects the vast majority. Thelen's media persona can be polarizing.
- **German language:** German-first culture; pitch in EN is fine but bring a DE-speaker to the meeting.

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12. Tengelmann Ventures

- **Website:** Tengelmann Ventures
- **HQ:** Munich (parent Tengelmann Group is Mülheim-based retail giant: OBI, KiK, BABOR)
- **Check size:** €1M–€10M (Series A-focused; will do seed selectively)
- **Thesis:** Consumer-focused B2C/B2B; eCommerce, marketplaces, retail tech.
- **Consumer/Wellness fit: YES (thesis) / Partial (stage)** — they love consumer but rarely write pre-seed tickets.
- **Key partners:** Christian Winter (Managing Director), Jens Christian Wussow (Partner)
- **Portfolio comps:** Zalando (exit), Delivery Hero (exit), Klarna (exit), SumUp, Scalable Capital, Edurino.
- **Intro vector:** Warm intro strongly preferred. Their parent retail network (OBI, KiK, BABOR) is a strategic value-add for commerce startups.
- **Fit score: 6/10** — right thesis, wrong stage for €500K ask. Keep them warm for a seed round in 12 months.
- **Red flags:** No 2026 deals yet. Pre-seed is off-thesis.
- **German language:** Accepts EN; leadership is DE.

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13. Project A Ventures

- **Website:** project-a.vc (verified active)
- **HQ:** Berlin
- **Pre-seed check:** €1M–€8M
- **AUM:** €1.2B (Fund V: €325M, 2025)
- **Thesis: Fund V has explicitly shifted AWAY from consumer** toward European Resilience (defense), Fintech, Autonomous Work, Supply Chains.
- **Consumer/Wellness fit: Partial** — legacy consumer bets exist (Bene Bono, Catawiki) but Fund V is not the target.
- **Key partners:** Florian Heinemann, Uwe Horstmann — both Berlin operators but now deep in B2B.
- **Fit score: 5/10** — thesis has drifted. Skip unless you get a warm intro.
- **Red flags:** Off-thesis for consumer/wellness in 2026.
- **German language:** EN fine.

14. HV Capital (ex-HV Holtzbrinck)

- **Website:** hvcapital.com (verified active)
- **HQ:** Munich + Berlin
- **Pre-seed check:** €100K–€500K via their streamlined Seed Program (4-week close commitment)
- **AUM:** €2.8B
- **Thesis:** Fund IX (€710M) — consumer tech + healthcare + B2B software + AI.
- **Consumer/Wellness fit: Partial** — historic consumer champions (Zalando, HelloFresh, FlixBus) but current focus has grown bigger.
- **Key partners to target:**
- Jan Miczaika (Partner, seed program leader — fastest decisions)
- Lars Langusch (Partner, consumer)
- **Portfolio comps:** HelloFresh, FlixBus, Zalando, SumUp.
- **Intro vector:** Apply to seed program directly. They promise 2-week decision + 2-week close.
- **Fit score: 6/10** — historic fit is high; current fund skews growth-ier. Seed program is ideal for €500K.
- **Red flags:** Their typical sweet spot is €2M+ seed; €500K pre-seed is on the low end but the seed program is built for exactly that.
- **German language:** EN fine.

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15. Earlybird Venture Capital (incl. Earlybird-X for pre-seed)

- **Website:** earlybird.com (verified active)
- **HQ:** Berlin + Munich + London
- **Pre-seed check:** ~€500K–€1.5M (Earlybird-X is the pre-seed vehicle)
- **AUM:** €2B
- **Thesis:** Digital West fund, Digital East, Health (separate), and **Earlybird-X for pre-seed Western Europe**.
- **Consumer/Wellness fit: Partial** — Health fund leans clinical; Digital West does consumer but Oviva is the primary consumer-health bet.
- **Key partners:** Fabian Heilemann (Partner, Berlin), Christian Nagel (Founding Partner).
- **Portfolio comps:** Oviva (digital health/weight management — closest consumer-health match), NeoTaste.
- **Intro vector:** Warm intro preferred; Berlin events are active channel.
- **Fit score: 6/10** — if Earlybird-X partner is consumer-leaning the fit is good; otherwise Digital Health fund is a mismatch.
- **Red flags:** The Health fund is for clinical not consumer wellness.
- **German language:** EN fine.

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16. Cavalry Ventures (now NAP)

- **Website:** nap.vc (formerly cavalry.vc; rebranded Feb 2025)
- **HQ:** Berlin
- **Pre-seed check:** €1M–€4M (€500K–€2M per some sources)
- **AUM:** €260M+
- **Thesis:** Enterprise + consumer software; "nerds and pioneers on tough problems."
- **Consumer/Wellness fit: Partial** — they say consumer software; strict consumer-brand fit is less proven.
- **Key partners:** Rouven Dresselhaus, Claude Ritter, Stefan Walter (all founding partners).
- **Portfolio comps:** Medbelle, Xaver.
- **Intro vector:** Daily investment committee — they pride themselves on speed. Direct submission + warm intros both work.
- **Fit score: 5/10** — software-brand focus doesn't perfectly map to a content-driven commerce play.
- **Red flags:** Rebrand confusion + check size often above €500K pre-seed.
- **German language:** EN fine.

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17. Picus Capital

- **Website:** picuscap.com
- **HQ:** Munich (NOT Berlin — despite frequent listing)
- **Check size:** Evergreen, flexible — pre-seed to Series A
- **Thesis:** Real estate, finance/insurance, HR, renewable energy, mobility, health.
- **Consumer/Wellness fit: Partial** — Avi (patient-doctor tech), Khumbu (medicine discovery), Napo (pet insurance).
- **Key partners:** Robin Godenrath, Florian Reichert.
- **Intro vector:** They actively co-create companies with founders — apply to their company-building program.
- **Fit score: 6/10** — health is a thesis pillar; consumer-wellness is less proven.
- **Red flags:** Munich-based (less Berlin presence); they prefer large long-term stakes.
- **German language:** EN fine.

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18. 468 Capital

- **Website:** 468cap.com (verified active)
- **HQ:** Berlin + SF
- **Check size:** Not publicly disclosed; seed avg round $4.77M participation
- **Thesis:** Deep tech, software, marketplaces, **digital consumer and prosumer**, AI/ML, climate.
- **Consumer/Wellness fit: Partial** — "digital consumer and prosumer" is in their listed thesis; portfolio leans B2B.
- **Key partners:** Ludwig Ensthaler (Partner), Florian Leibert (Founding Partner, ex-Mesosphere).
- **Portfolio comps:** Aleph Alpha, Superchat, Oro, Razor Group.
- **Intro vector:** Warm intro via their SF or Berlin office; Leibert is accessible on Twitter/X.
- **Fit score: 6/10** — AI angle of Alche fits; consumer-brand angle is secondary for them.
- **German language:** EN fine.

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19. Heal Capital

- **Website:** healcapital.com (verified active)
- **HQ:** Berlin
- **Pre-seed check:** €1M–€5M
- **AUM:** €200M+
- **Thesis:** HealthTech + AI; explicitly backed by 25+ health insurers and pharma.
- **Consumer/Wellness fit: Partial** — HealthTech lens is provider/payer-facing more than consumer. Alche's consumer brand positioning would need framing.
- **Key partners:** Markus Muschenich (Founding Partner), Christian Weiss (Partner).
- **Portfolio comps:** Gleamer (exit), FormlyAI.
- **Intro vector:** Active in Berlin health conferences + Merantix network.
- **Fit score: 5/10** — misalignment between their clinical/insurance framing and Alche's consumer brand story. Possible later-stage co-investor.
- **Red flags:** LP base (insurers, pharma) prefers regulated health not consumer wellness.
- **German language:** EN fine.

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20. b2venture (formerly btov Partners)

- **Website:** b2venture.vc (verified active)
- **HQ:** St. Gallen (CH) + Berlin + Luxembourg
- **Pre-seed check:** €250K–€3.5M
- **Thesis:** Digital + industrial tech; sectors include AI, fintech, biotech, deep tech, insurtech, digital health.
- **Consumer/Wellness fit: Partial** — Urban Sports Club is the signature consumer wellness bet.
- **Key partners:** Florian Schweitzer, Robert Gallenberger, Andreas Göldi.

- **Portfolio comps:** Urban Sports Club (wellness marketplace), several digital health bets.
- **Intro vector:** Their 250+ angel network is a unique structural advantage. Apply via website or warm intro via their angel network.
- **Fit score: 5/10** — consumer wellness is a side bet not a core thesis. The angel network value-add is the reason to stay in touch.
- **German language:** DE/EN both fine; Swiss/German team.

Noted but Not Prioritized

- **La Famiglia / General Catalyst Berlin** — merged into GC in June 2024; currently B2B-focused (Personio, Deel, Forto, Y42). Consumer pre-seed is not their current thesis even though GC US invests broadly in consumer. **Fit score: 4/10** — skip for this round, revisit at Series A.
- **Lakestar** — Strategic pivot to DefenseTech + concentrated bets; consumer pre-seed is off-thesis. **Fit score: 3/10.**
- **Global Founders Capital / GFC (Rocket Internet)** — Restructured 2024 to balance sheet investing; sharply reduced deal volume (6 deals in last 12 months globally). Very B2B/fintech-heavy in 2025-2026. **Fit score: 4/10.**
- **Point Nine Capital** — Primarily B2B SaaS. **Fit score: 3/10.**
- **Capnamic Ventures** — Primarily B2B (LeanIX, Staffbase, Adjust). **Fit score: 3/10.**
- **Redstone** — Seed/Series A not pre-seed; not consumer-focused. **Fit score: 3/10.**
- **Signals VC** — Explicitly B2B enterprise. **Fit score: 2/10.**
- **DvH Ventures** — Cologne-based; primarily fintech + digital health (clinical). **Fit score: 4/10.**
- **Fly Ventures** — AI-technical founders; not consumer. **Fit score: 3/10.**

Notes on Fund Landscape for Alche

- **The Berlin/DACH pre-seed consumer fund pool is genuinely narrow.** Only 4-5 funds (Vorwerk, Heartcore, Shio, Cherry, Calm/Storm) have consumer wellness as an actual thesis. The rest are "we sometimes do consumer" — meaning you'll be an atypical deal and need strong comps.
- **Xiaohongshu as a comp is likely unfamiliar in DACH.** Always pair it with AG1 ($600M), Ritual, Thrive Market, and Kaia Health (Berlin exit) for local resonance.
- **Germany's €7.2B supplements market is a non-obvious edge.** Most DACH VCs underestimate the category size; lead your pitch with the Sunday Natural / BRAINEFFECT comps which are known to German investors.
- **BRAINEFFECT (acquired by Schwabe Pharma in 2025) deliberately avoided VC.** This will come up — be ready with why Alche's AI-first approach changes the math vs. pure-CPG.
- **Her.one (her1) is the cleanest Berlin comp.** €5.5M Series A led by Five Seasons Ventures with Rheingau Founders + IBB Ventures. Those three names deserve direct outreach as they've already bet on this exact thesis.
- **Female/queer founder angle is a real advantage** through Auxxo, Calm/Storm, Female Founders Fund F, and IBB Ventures (which backed her1).
- **Language:** English is broadly accepted by all 20 funds. IBB Ventures + Freigeist skew most German-first on paperwork. Founder is Berlin-based which resolves any "why DE?" question immediately.